Endocrinology Service Line Handbook

MERIDIAN HEALTH PARTNERS ## OPERATIONS POLICY MANUAL ### SECTION 4: SERVICE LINE HANDBOOKS #### SUB-SECTION 4.12: ENDOCRINOLOGY DEPARTMENT

4.12.1 PURPOSE AND SCOPE This document establishes the operational standards, scheduling parameters, administrative workflows, and insurance coverage matrices for the Endocrinology Department across all 14 Meridian Health Partners outpatient facilities. Compliance with this policy is mandatory for all clinic managers, scheduling coordinators, and financial counselors.

4.12.2 CONDITIONS ACCEPTED AND EXPLICITLY NOT ACCEPTED 1. Accepted Conditions: The Endocrinology Department accepts adult patients (aged 18 and older) presenting with: * Type 1 and Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus requiring complex management. * Thyroid disorders, including hypothyroidism, hyperthyroidism, thyroid nodules, and post-thyroidectomy management. * Adrenal insufficiency, Cushing's syndrome, and incidentalomas. * Pituitary disorders, including prolactinomas, acromegaly, and hypopituitarism. * Calcium and bone metabolism disorders, specifically osteoporosis and hyperparathyroidism. * Reproductive endocrinology limited to polycystic ovary syndrome (PCOS) and hypogonadism.

2. Explicitly Not Accepted Conditions: The department does not schedule, evaluate, or treat:
* Pediatric endocrinology cases (patients under the age of 18 must be referred to Valley Children's Health Network).
* Active bariatric surgical candidates requiring preoperative clearance only (managed by the Meridian Bariatric Service Line).
* Transgender hormone initiation and maintenance therapy (managed by the Meridian Primary Care Gender-Affirming Care clinics).
* Gestational diabetes mellitus (redirected to Maternal-Fetal Medicine at affiliated regional hospitals).

4.12.3 APPOINTMENT DURATIONS Scheduling templates are standardized across all 14 sites to ensure consistent patient throughput. 1. New Patient Consultations: Allocated a duration of 40 minutes. 2. Follow-Up Visits: Allocated a duration of 20 minutes. 3. Continuous Glucose Monitor (CGM) / Insulin Pump Training Sessions: Allocated a duration of 60 minutes, conducted by a Certified Diabetes Care and Education Specialist (CDCES). 4. Procedure and Stimulation Testing Visits (e.g., Cosyntropin stimulation tests): Allocated a duration of 90 minutes.

4.12.4 PATIENT PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS Scheduling coordinators must issue the following preparation protocols at the time of booking: 1. Fasting Laboratory Work: Patients scheduled for initial consultations or annual reviews must complete required fasting blood glucose and lipid panels at a Meridian

Pathology lab exactly 12 hours prior to the appointment time. Water is permitted. 2. Device Data Uploads: Patients utilizing continuous glucose monitors or smart insulin pumps must upload their device data to the manufacturer cloud platform 48 hours prior to their scheduled visit to allow clinician review. 3. Medication Logs: Patients must bring all current prescription bottles, over-the-counter supplements, and a physical or digital log of blood glucose readings recorded over the preceding 14 consecutive days.

4.12.5 INSURANCE COVERAGE MATRIX Meridian Health Partners operates four proprietary health plans. Coverage of specific endocrinology procedures varies by plan tier as detailed below:

Procedure / Service	MeridianSelect (Tier 1)	MeridianValue (Tier 2)	MeridianAccess (Tier 3)	MeridianPremier (Tier 4)
Initial Consultation	Covered in full ($0 copay)	Covered ($20 copay)	Covered ($40 copay)	Covered in full ($0 copay)
Continuous Glucose Monitor (CGM) Initiation	Covered (Prior Auth required)	Covered (Prior Auth required)	Not Covered	Covered in full ($0 copay)
Diagnostic Ultrasound-Guided Thyroid FNA Biopsy	Covered in full ($0 copay)	Covered (15% coinsurance)	Covered (30% coinsurance)	Covered in full ($0 copay)
Insulin Pump Therapy Management	Covered	Covered (Prior Auth required)	Not Covered	Covered
Bone Density Scan (DXA)	Covered in full	Covered ($15 copay)	Covered ($35 copay)	Covered in full

4.12.6 REFERRAL TURNAROUND COMMITMENT 1. Standard Internal Referrals: The Endocrinology Department commits to reviewing and scheduling all internal primary care provider referrals within 3 business days of receipt in the electronic health record queue. 2. External Referrals: Referrals originating from non-Meridian provider networks must be processed, verified for insurance authorization, and scheduled within 5 business days of receipt by the central intake fax unit. 3. Urgent Referrals: Referrals marked as urgent by the originating physician (e.g., suspected thyrotoxic crisis or newly diagnosed severe hypercalcemia) must be triaged by the on-call endocrinologist within 4 business hours for direct-to-clinic direct admission or urgent same-day slot allocation.

Document ID: SOP-ENDO-4.12
Effective Date: January 15, 2026

Approved By: Dr. Aris Thorne, Chief Medical Officer, Meridian Health Partners
Applies To: All 14 Meridian Health Partners Clinic Locations